



MONEY YOU'RE OWED

Salary Negotiation Pack

Market worksheet, offer script, raise script, and fallback menu

Complete free answer for V09. It gives a process, not a guaranteed raise.

1. Market-range worksheet

- Exact occupation/title: _____
- Location: _____
- CareerOneStop/BLS typical range: _____
- Role responsibilities beyond the standard title:

• _____

- Relevant experience, license, scarce skill or measurable result:

• _____

• _____

- Evidence-based target range: _____

- Fallback package: _____

- Private walk-away point: _____

Use careeronestop.org/Toolkit/Wages/find-salary.aspx. Its Salary Finder uses Bureau of Labor Statistics OEWS data. Do not simply choose the highest number shown.

2. New-job offer script

Thank you — I'm excited about the role. Based on the responsibilities, my experience with **[relevant skill/result]**, and the market range for this position in **[location]**, I was targeting **[range]**. Is there flexibility to move the base closer to that range?

Then stop. Let the employer respond. Do not fill the silence by lowering your own request.

If they ask "Why that range?"

The strongest match is **[specific experience/result]**, plus **[second relevant skill]**. Those directly support **[important responsibility in the job description]**.

3. Raise conversation script

I'd like to discuss my compensation based on the scope I'm handling and the results since **[date/review]**. I've delivered **[result one]**, **[result two]**, and **[expanded responsibility]**. The current market range for comparable work in **[location]** is **[range]**. What would need to happen to move my base to **[target]**?

If the answer is "not now," ask for a written review date and measurable criteria.

4. Total-compensation checklist

Before you counter, write down the complete offer: - ☐ Base salary / hourly rate - ☐ Bonus or commission formula and conditions - ☐ Health, dental, disability and life coverage - ☐ Retirement match and vesting - ☐ Paid time off and holidays - ☐ Remote/hybrid schedule and working hours - ☐ Signing bonus - ☐ Training, tuition, dues or certification support - ☐ Equity/stock terms where applicable - ☐ Start date and first salary-review date - ☐ Repayment, clawback or other contingencies

5. If base pay cannot move

Ask which **one or two** items have flexibility: - Signing bonus - Earlier salary review with written goals - Additional paid time off - Remote/hybrid days or schedule - Training/certification budget - Title or role scope - Professional dues, parking or travel support - Start date

6. Final check

- ☐ Positive, brief and evidence-based — not personal financial need
- ☐ No fabricated offer, result, title or market figure
- ☐ Final package received in writing
- ☐ Background checks, start date, bonus rules and contingencies understood before resigning elsewhere

Rights boundary

Many private-sector workers covered by the National Labor Relations Act can discuss wages and working conditions. Coverage has exceptions, and state/local rules differ. Check your status rather than assuming every worker has identical protection.

Official sources

- CareerOneStop salary negotiation: careeronestop.org/JobSearch/Interview/negotiate-your-salary.aspx
- Salary Finder: careeronestop.org/Toolkit/Wages/find-salary.aspx
- BLS OEWS: bls.gov/oes/
- NLRB wage discussions: nlrb.gov/about-nlrb/rights-we-protect/the-law/employees/your-right-to-discuss-wages

Money You're Owed · General education, not legal, tax or career advice. No script guarantees a raise; workplace rules and employer policies vary. Accurate as of July 2026.